



YİĞİT ÖZEN

THIRTY-FIVE WORKS

Paintings since 2019

ISTANBUL · MILAN · LUXEMBOURG

YIGITOZEN.XYZ

Thirty-five paintings

2019–2026 · ISTANBUL, MILAN AND LUXEMBOURG

Eight of thirty-five works made since 2019 across Istanbul, Milan and Luxembourg. The whole book, with every detail and the stages of the newest paintings, is at yigitozen.xyz/artbook.

MEDIUM

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS, ON CARTON AND ON PAPER, AND ONE DRAWING IN CHARCOAL

ORDER

NEWEST FIRST, SO THE SEVEN YEARS ARE READ BACKWARDS

RIGHTS

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Paintings since 2019

THIRTY-FIVE WORKS

NEWEST FIRST

ON THE WORK

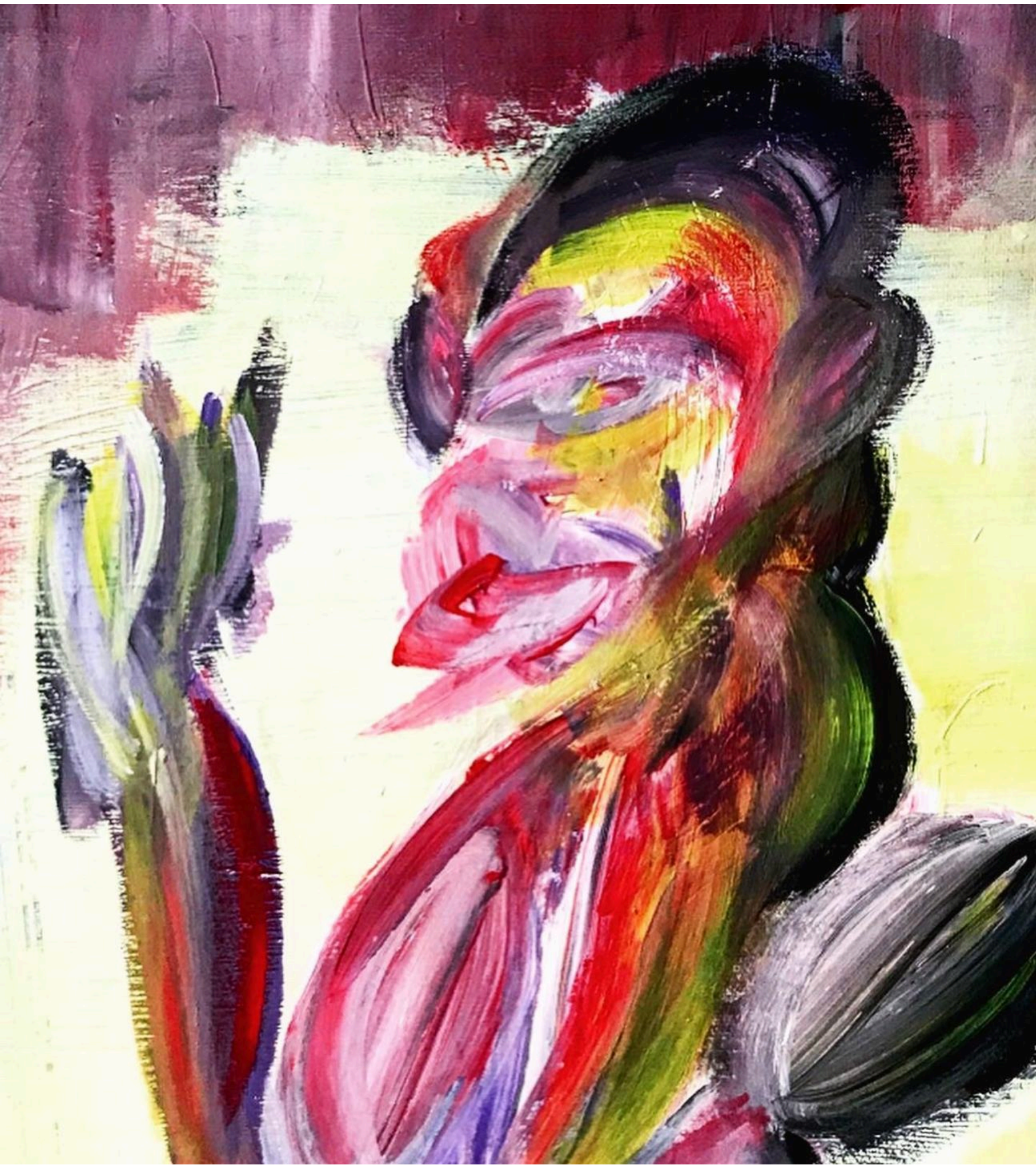
The figures in these paintings are assembled rather than drawn whole. A body accumulates out of clusters of rounded cells and bubbles that lean against one another, and it may close or stay open: which way it goes belongs to where that figure stands in the scene and to what it is thinking there. Bodies and faces are the medium the work is made in, and the question they carry is an existential one. What lies behind them is not a backdrop but a place, and those places work as dimensions.

The decisions are taken in wet paint, on the spot. Layer goes over layer like a palimpsest, and they are not layers of light and shadow: they are colour clusters of movement, energy, aura and feeling. Large areas of ground are left bare, and they carry as much weight as the painted part.

Familiar compositional formats are kept while the agreement that made them legible is withdrawn: an object is held out, a sign is displayed, and what either stands for is never supplied. Titles act as a second body in the scene, bending the image instead of describing it. Power appears as a distribution of weight, one figure left underneath the stack. At the edges a small onlooker sits with its eyes closed and its mouth sewn shut, so the witness is cancelled before anything can be reported. Scale works as a verdict, one face given as a person and the rest reduced to signs, sometimes a face replaced by a number.

ON THE WORK

TEXT BY THE ARTIST



ON THE WORK

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Yiğit Özen

BORN 1994, ISTANBUL



Yiğit Özen was born in 1994 in Istanbul and trained as an architect.

The painting dates from 2018 onward. The thirty-five works in this book were made between 2019 and 2026, across Istanbul, Milan and Luxembourg.

From 2020 the studio work went largely to XR and spatial design, and the canvases thin out to one commission in 2023 before the painting resumes in 2026. The years are given as they fall rather than smoothed over.

Alongside the paintings, Özen works as an XR and spatial web designer, and is the founder of decentralize design in Milan and Virtually Ever After in Luxembourg.

PAINTER AND SPATIAL DESIGNER

STUDIO, LUXEMBOURG

PAINTING, SELECTED EXHIBITIONS	POWER OF THE NATURE, FABBRICA DEL VAPORE, MILAN	2019
	THE ARTS SPECIAL PROJECTS, FABBRICA DEL VAPORE, MILAN	2019
XR AND SPATIAL DESIGN, SELECTED	COMMUNITAS III BY KOLLEKTIV KOLLEKTIV, KUNSTHAUS STEFFISBURG	2021
	NEW FREEDOM THINK, MADS GALLERY, MILAN	2022
	ART DESIGN, HOLY ART GALLERY, LONDON	2022
	DYOR, KUNSTHALLE ZÜRICH, ZÜRICH	2022
	CREATORS OF THE METAVERSE BY METAMUNDO, ART BASEL MIAMI	2022
	NEW CODES BY VCA, DRAUP AND MAD GLOBAL, ROYAL INSTITUTION, LONDON	2023
TALKS	VCA MENTORSHIP, 6TH COHORT, ARCHITECTURE IN THE METAVERSE	2023
	OPENING KEYNOTE, DIGITAL FASHION SUMMIT, CREATIVE DENMARK	2024

THE PAINTING AND THE DESIGN PRACTICE ARE LISTED APART

01	7 FAM BOARD GAME	2026	10
02	VIRGIL ON VIRTUAL CAGE (FINAL_FINAL-FINALV9)	2026	14
03	GARY GRILLS COOPER	2026	18
04	WALLS OF PERCEPTION	2026	0
05	ARTICULO ATTACK ON MANDARIN	2026	22
06	S(T)LOP	2026	0
07	PENGUIN IS NOT A FRIEND, ONLY A SINNER	2023	0
08	CIAO CAPO, SONO SQUALO	2020	26
09	CELLULAR SPLEENS	2020	0
10	CUTE BUT UNEMPLOYED CARTOON FIGURE	2020	0
11	THE FAMILY DINNER AFTER A NIGHT IN JAİL	2020	0
12	CAPROCORN SISTER: WAR, PLAGUE, EARTHQUAKE	2020	0
13	BABY RIGHTS 101	2020	0
14	WHEN THE DARKNESS SURROUNDS, BE AMONG THOSE WHO BURN THE GREAT FIRE	2020	0
15	VIPERELLA	2020	30
16	BACCHUS 2	2020	0
17	THE ON-TOP RULER	2020	0
18	SIN OVER BLACK MATTER	2019	0

EACH WORK OPENS ON A SPREAD: THE NOTE, THEN THE PAINTING

19	THE ASSASSINATION OF THE CROW	2019	0
20	DESPITE TRANSGRESSION	2019	0
21	DUALITY OF THE ANGELIC SUMMARIZATION	2019	0
22	VICTIM PSYCHO-LOGIQUE II : THE PEACHY PHARAOH CONNECTS WITH THE CHAIR	2019	34
23	GUARDING HOLY MOUNTAINS FROM MALICE	2019	0
24	GOOD PEOPLE HELPING BAD ONES (THAT'S WHY THEY'RE BAD TOO)	2019	0
25	AMOR CATHEDRA	2019	0
26	BURNINGMAN FAST	2019	0
27	IL SBAGLIATO DI ROMPIPALLE	2019	0
28	MORBID FOREBODINGS TRIGGERED BY CHILDISH LANDSCAPE	2019	0
29	WINGS OF ABYSS	2019	0
30	SEE U IN THE OTHER SIDE	2019	0
31	SOCIETY SCREWING BALANCE	2019	0
32	HOW TO MATERIALIZE YOUR LONELINESS BY USING AN ANIMAL IN SOMEWHERE CONCRETE OR TECHNOLOGIC	2019	0
33	CENTURY OF 0 & 1 / TRANSHUMANISM	2019	0
34	REMIXED EXECUTION OF LUCID DROWNING	2019	0
35	TWO WOMAN FIGURES SITTING AT THE BACK OF THE CANVAS	2019	36

EACH WORK OPENS ON A SPREAD: THE NOTE, THEN THE PAINTING

7 fam board game

100 × 80 CM · 39 ⅞ × 31 ½ IN

One side stands wrapped, each cone clear of the next; the other is stacked two and three high until one head cannot be told from another. Those are the two ways of being a family available on this board, and the game is between them. Nothing has been taken off, so whatever is being played is not the kind of game that ends with a winner. The larger of the two heads has neither eyes nor a mouth; the small one opposite it is all glare.

COLOUR

WARM AND COOL LEVEL AT ABOUT A THIRD EACH, CYAN THE LARGEST FAMILY, GREEN UNDER TWO IN A THOUSAND

COMPOSITION

A BOARD TURNED CORNER ON, ITS NEAR POINT THE ONE CORNER SHOWN WHOLE, TWO HEADS AT OPPOSITE SCALES

HAND

LOBES TURNED WET INTO WET FOR THE HEADS, THE WRAPPINGS AND THE FACES DRAWN LAST WITH A THIN TIP





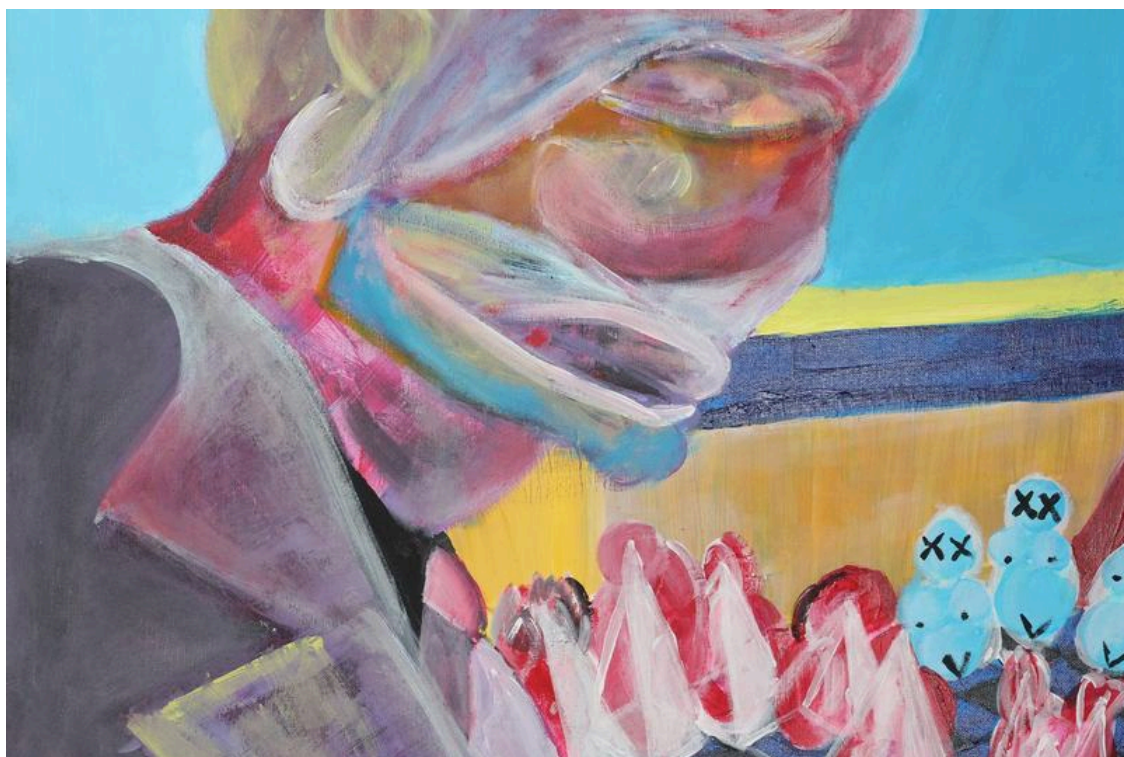
THE RIGHT PLAYER'S HEAD



THE LEFT PLAYER'S HEAD



THE BLUE SIDE, RANGED ON THE BOARD



THE LEFT PLAYER ABOVE THE NEAR CONES



THE LEFT PLAYER'S HEAD, CLOSER

Virgil on Virtual Cage (final_final-finalV9)

80 × 100 CM · 31 ½ × 39 ⅞ IN

The cage is drawn, not built. A few white lines lay a ceiling across the top and drop two uprights, then stop two fifths of the way down, so nothing is actually shut in. Underneath, the bodies are soft, pressed from the tube and scratched while still wet, and not one of them looks at the lines. The title carries a guide out of the underworld and a file name that has been saved as final nine times over: two promises of an ending, made by something that has none.

COLOUR

THREE QUARTERS WARM, COOL UNDER
FOUR PER CENT, THE WHITE WIG THE
LIGHTEST POINT

COMPOSITION

A WHITE LINED BOX THAT PROMISES TO
ENCLOSE AND STOPS AT TWO FIFTHS OF
THE HEIGHT

HAND

GRAINY PINK PRESSED FROM THE TUBE
AND SCRATCHED WHILE WET, AGAINST
FLAT OPAQUE LINE





02 · THE BLONDE HEAD AT THE RIGHT

DETAIL



THE WHITE BOX DRAWN OVER THE TOP



THE RECLINING BODY IN THE CORAL BED



02 · THE CHAIR DRAWN ON THE PINK PANEL

DETAIL



THE RIGHT SIDE, AND THE WING BEHIND THE SHOULDER

gary grills cooper

55 × 75 CM · 21 ⁷/₈ × 29 ¹/₂ IN

“Whatever happened to Gary Cooper? The strong, silent type. That was an American. He wasn’t in touch with his feelings. He just did what he had to do.”

The quotation mourns a man who did not have to know what he felt. The painting gives him back as a stack of coloured balls with a cigar in it, the one straight line in the picture falling from his mouth, and sets a pan of coals at his feet. Grilling is the only thing he is doing, and the title has already broken his name in half to fit the joke.

COLOUR

NINE TENTHS WARM, TWO TURQUOISE
SCRATCHES AT WAIST HEIGHT THE ONLY
COOL

COMPOSITION

A FRONTAL ORDER BROKEN BY ONE
STRAIGHT ROD FALLING LEFT FROM THE
MOUTH

HAND

SEMI TRANSPARENT TOUCHES LAID
UPWARD IN THE PAN, A NEAR EMPTY
BRUSH ACROSS THE TURQUOISE





THE SHOULDER, BUILT FROM LOBES



THE LOBES OF THE CHEST



THE HANDS, AND THE ROD BETWEEN THEM



THE PAN AT THE LOWER LEFT



THE FOREARM CROSSING THE WAIST

articulo attack on mandarin

80 × 80 CM · 31 ½ × 31 ½ IN

The flock is already committed, every wing swept the same way down the diagonal, and the row of figures standing along the boat does not look up. Each of them has an X where the eyes should be, so there is nobody aboard to see it coming. The anchor lies in the corner with its chain beside it. One thin figure at the centre holds the pole, which is the only act in the painting, and it cannot be told whether it is steering or holding on.

COLOUR

BLUE, GREY, WHITE AND BLACK ONLY,
CONTRAST CARRIED BY VALUE AND NOT
BY HUE

COMPOSITION

A FLOCK ON THE MAIN DIAGONAL, UPPER
RIGHT TO LOWER LEFT, OVER A ROW OF
FIGURES A THIRD UP

HAND

A LOADED BRUSH FLUNG SIDEWAYS,
BRISTLES SPLITTING, NO WING ENTERED
TWICE





THE FIGURE AT THE POLE



THE FLOCK, UPPER MIDDLE



TWO BIRDS, MID FLIGHT



THE ROW OF FIGURES ON THE
BOAT



A BIRD LOW AT THE LEFT

ciao capo, sono squalo

65 × 90 CM · 25 $\frac{7}{8}$ × 35 $\frac{3}{8}$ IN

The pointed teeth ranged in the open mouth of the figure on the left stand as the one sharp edge within the softness of the rest of the painting. The title gives this mouth a sentence: hello boss, I am the shark. An Italian and overly cheerful greeting, the opening line of someone introducing himself as a predator.

COLOUR

FIVE NAMES ONLY, AND BLUE OCCURS IN THE BODIES ALONE AND CARRIES THE WHOLE DIVISION

COMPOSITION

TWO VERTICAL MASSES SHARING THE FRAME, THREE FEET AT THE LEFT AND TWO AT THE RIGHT

HAND

ONE TURNING PULL PER EGG UNIT, NEVER ENTERED TWICE, OVER A NEAR DRY COMBED WALL





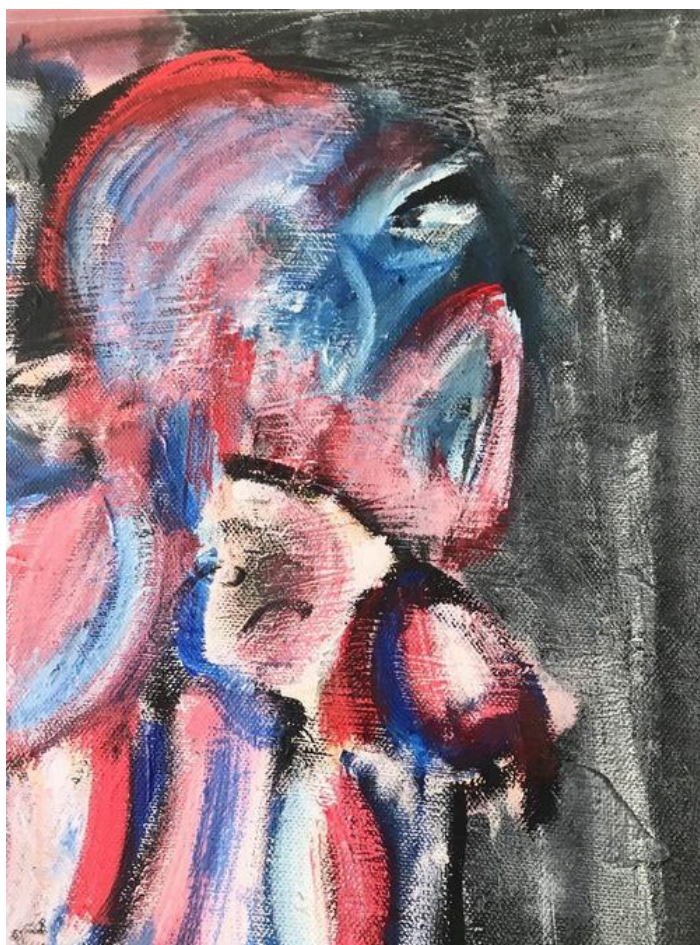
THE BODY, EGG OVER EGG



THE LEFT HEAD, AND ITS TEETH



THE RIGHT HEAD, IN PROFILE



THE RIGHT FIGURE AGAINST THE BLACK



THE FEET ON THE WHITE STRIP

viperella

50 × 70 CM · 19 5/8 × 27 1/2 IN

A dark band closes in from all four sides and leaves within it a light green rectangle between lemon and pistachio, setting up a second frame inside the painting. The figure is placed right in the middle of that bright field, standing in profile.

COLOUR

A LIGHT INNER FIELD AGAINST A DARK OUTER BELT, THE BODY ITSELF IN NO COLOUR FAMILY

COMPOSITION

A SECOND FRAME PAINTED INSIDE THE PICTURE WITH THE FIGURE AT ITS MIDDLE

HAND

THIN HORIZONTAL GROUND LETTING THE WEAVE SHOW, LOADED CURVES FOR THE MASSES, DARK STROKES LAST





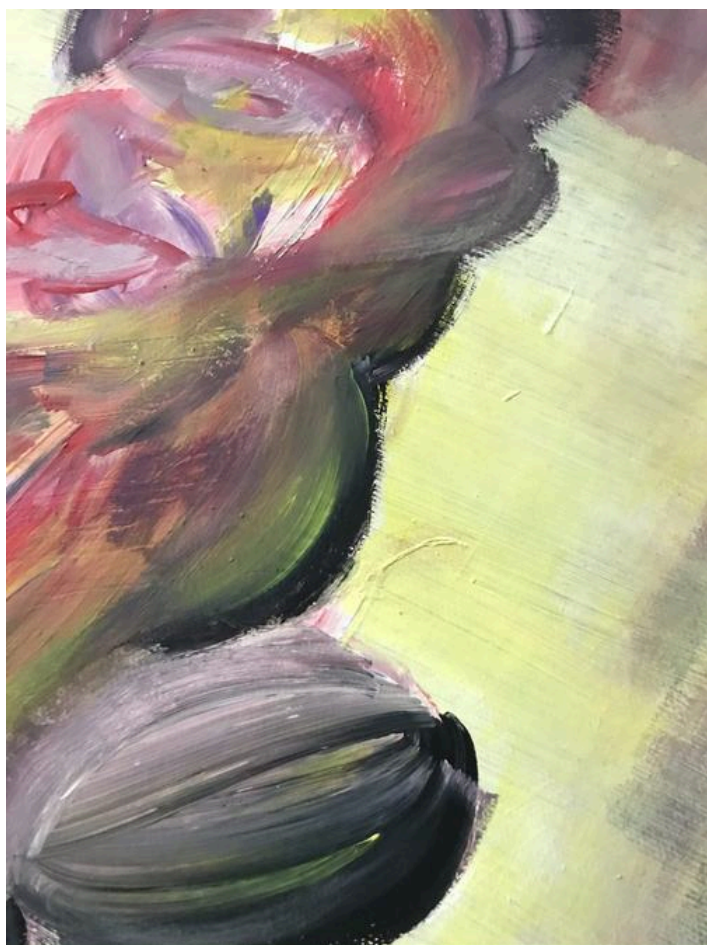
THE HEAD, AND THE RAISED HAND



THE HIP, TURNING



WHERE THE LIGHT FIELD MEETS THE
BELT



THE CHEST, AND THE GREY LOBE



THE RED MARK IN THE TOP RIGHT CORNER

victim psycho-logique II : the peachy pharaoh connects with the chair

65 × 90 CM · 25 7/8 × 35 3/8 IN

A peach-coloured body stands doubled over on a diagonal running from lower left to upper right, its heaviest mass gathered right at the level of the belly, the legs that bear it thin and long; the borne is heavy, the bearer weak.

COLOUR

HALF A SINGLE BLUE PURPLE AGAINST THE PEACH YELLOW BODY, OPPOSITE ENDS OF THE WHEEL

COMPOSITION

THREE UNITS LEFT TO RIGHT, A HANGING TOY, A BODY COLLAPSED ON A CHAIR, AN EMPTY CHAIR IN LINE

HAND

FLAT GROUND IN ONE COAT, THE BODY RUBBED SOFT INSIDE A THICK BLACK CONTOUR, ONE CHAIR UNPAINTED



two woman figures sitting at the back of the canvas

65 × 90 CM · 25 ⁷/₈ × 35 ³/₈ IN

The stretcher bars and the central rail are visible just as they are; two female figures are drawn in charcoal on the unpainted back face of the canvas, that is the side normally left turned to the wall.

COLOUR

NO PAINT AT ALL, THE RANGE RUNNING BETWEEN CHARCOAL BLACK AND RAW CLOTH WHITE

COMPOSITION

THE STRETCHER CROSSBAR DIVIDING THE BACK INTO TWO EQUAL PANELS, ONE FIGURE IN EACH

HAND

CHARCOAL ON UNPRIMED CLOTH, HOLDING TO THE CRESTS OF THE WEAVE WITH NO BINDER



The onlooker

Cogs, and they believe in the work

A small figure turns up in eight of these paintings, built from stacked circles, an X drawn over each eye and in one of them a mouth stitched shut. It is never the subject. It stands at the foot of the heap, in a row along a boat, hung upside down in a corner, ranged across a board.

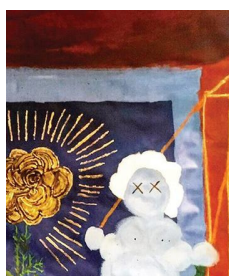
They are the functionaries. Emptied of anything of their own, put there to serve a purpose, and, as far as anything in the painting shows, convinced they are doing some good. The X is not violence done to them; it is the condition of the job. Present at the scene, and unable to report it.



01 · 2026 · BLUE, STACKED TWO AND THREE HIGH, RANGED ACROSS THE BOARD



05 · 2026 · A ROW OF THEM STANDING ALONG THE BOAT



20 · 2019 · WHITE AND TUFTED, CROSSED EYES AND A STITCHED MOUTH



22 · 2019 · OVOID CLUSTERS MARKED WITH AN X, HUNG AT THE UPPER LEFT



23 · 2019 · THREE OF THEM, ARMS LINKED, BEFORE THE MOUNTAIN



24 · 2019 · THREE AT THE FOOT OF THE WHITE HEAP, ONE FLOATING CLEAR OF IT



29 · 2019 · HUNG UPSIDE DOWN AT THE UPPER LEFT, FINGERS SPREAD



31 · 2019 · RED, DRAWN IN A CROWD, ONE OF THEM RAISED ABOVE THE REST

All works by Yiğit Özen, born 1994 in Istanbul and trained as an architect. Works are given newest first, so a paragraph that says a thing happens for the first time means the first time reading backwards through the book.

Dimensions are width by height, in centimetres.

Photography by the artist. Plates and details reproduce documentation of the paintings; colour and surface differ from the works themselves.

Where a paragraph gives a proportion or a percentage, it was measured on the documentation file rather than on the painting, and it describes that file. No colour target was used in the photography, so the figures are a reading of the photograph and not a colorimetric claim about the paint.

The epigraph on 03 is Tony Soprano, *The Sopranos*, HBO. The first frame of the process pages on 02 and 03 is a reference the painting was begun from and is credited on the page it appears.

A technical catalogue of the same works, with the full index, is published separately.

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